

Present Perfect vs Present Perfect Continuous

CEFR B2

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Both link the past to now. Choose by your focus:

- 1 Present perfect (simple) — the result or a completed quantity (I've written three emails).
- 2 Present perfect continuous — the activity and its duration (I've been writing all morning).

Finished result or a number → simple. Ongoing activity or 'how long' → continuous. Stative verbs use the simple only.

At a glance

	Present Perfect	Present Perfect Continuous
Focus	result / completed	activity / duration
Quantity	yes — I've read 3 books	no
How long	yes (with state verbs)	yes (for / since)
Example	I've painted the door.	I've been painting all morning.

Learning objectives

- Can choose between the present perfect simple and continuous by focus — result/quantity versus activity/duration (CEFR B2).
- Can avoid the continuous with quantities and stative verbs.
- Can use for/since with both forms.



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Present Perfect vs Present Perfect Continuous · CEFR B2

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. I ____ three emails this morning.

- A. 've been writing
- C. write

- B. 've written
- D. wrote

2. Sorry I'm late! How long ____ you ____?

- A. have / been waiting
- C. did / wait

- B. have / waited
- D. are / waiting

3. Your clothes are covered in paint! You ____.

- A. 've painted
- C. painted

- B. 've been painting
- D. paint

4. Great news — I ____ my essay at last!

- A. 've been finishing
- C. finish

- B. 've finished
- D. was finishing

5. We ____ each other since we were children.

- A. 've been knowing
- C. know

- B. 've known
- D. knew

6. He ____ ten kilometres today.

- A. 's been running
- C. runs

- B. 's run
- D. ran

7. I'm exhausted — I ____ all day.

- A. 've shopped
- C. shop

- B. 've been shopping
- D. shopped

8. At last, the builders ____ the bridge.

- A. 've been building
- C. build

- B. 've built
- D. built

9. Rewrite with the same meaning: 'I started waiting an hour ago and I'm still waiting.'

- A. I've waited an hour.
- C. I waited for an hour.

- B. I've been waiting for an hour.
- D. I wait for an hour.

10. Which sentence focuses on a finished number?

- A. I've been reading books all day.
- C. I've been reading since lunch.

- B. I've read four books this month.
- D. I read books at night.

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **B. 've written** — A completed number takes the present perfect simple: 'have written'.
2. **A. have / been waiting** — 'How long' + the ongoing activity takes the continuous: 'have you been waiting'.
3. **B. 've been painting** — A recent activity with a visible result now takes the continuous: 'have been painting'.
4. **B. 've finished** — A finished result takes the present perfect simple: 'have finished'.
5. **B. 've known** — State verbs take the present perfect simple: 'have known'.
6. **B. 's run** — A completed quantity takes the present perfect simple: 'has run'.
7. **B. 've been shopping** — A long activity with a result now (exhaustion) takes the continuous: 'have been shopping'.
8. **B. 've built** — A completed result takes the present perfect simple: 'have built'.
9. **B. I've been waiting for an hour.** — An action continuing up to now, focusing on duration, takes the continuous: 'have been waiting'.
10. **B. I've read four books this month.** — 'Four books' is a completed quantity, which takes the present perfect simple.